

Is water use per head low?

A public statement, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

“Per capita water consumption, today stands at around 110l/cap/day.”

Manuel Sapiano, Energy and Water Agency, IWRA 1st Island Water Congress, 2024

Slide 10 of the keynote slide deck.

The keynote makes no comparison with other countries; that wording came from the intake record.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Figure is close,
“low” is not benchmarked.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

120

Eurostat: households, 2024

Maltese households used about 120 litres per person per day (estimate); 116 in 2022.

+9%

Above the slide's 110

Within about 10% of the keynote's “around 110”; the slide does not define the measure.

176

All uses of the public supply

Litres per resident per day in 2024, including services such as hotels.

13th

Mid-table in the EU

13th lowest of 19 states with data, 8% above the median of 111 litres.

?

Tariff effect untested

No evidence in the deck that tariffs held use down; the schedule was not obtained.

FAIR TO SAY

The keynote does not claim Malta is lower than other countries. Its own deck says natural freshwater is insufficient even at efficient demand. We read slides, not a transcript.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The source and definition of the 110 litres.

☐ WSC billed domestic use, 2015–2024.

☐ The tariff schedule and its estimated effect.

☐ Population base used per person.